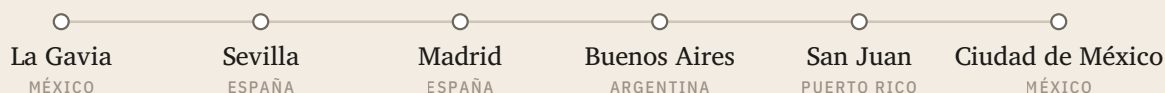


Destinos

What each episode teaches, written down once and kept: the words, the verbs, the grammar and the phrases worth remembering.



ESTE CUADERNO ES DE

EMPEZADO EL

Índice

1	La carta	<i>The letter</i>
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1

uno

La carta

The letter

WHERE LA GAVIA, MÉXICO



LA HISTORIA

What happens

Raquel Rodríguez es abogada. Vive y trabaja en Los Ángeles.

Don Fernando Castillo es un señor muy viejo y está enfermo. Vive en La Gavia, una hacienda en México.

Una señora de España, Teresa Suárez, le escribe una carta.

La carta habla de Rosario, la primera esposa de don Fernando. Él cree que Rosario murió en la Guerra Civil española.

Don Fernando quiere saber la verdad. Raquel va a investigar el caso, y su viaje empieza en Sevilla.

Raquel Rodríguez is a lawyer. She lives and works in Los Angeles.

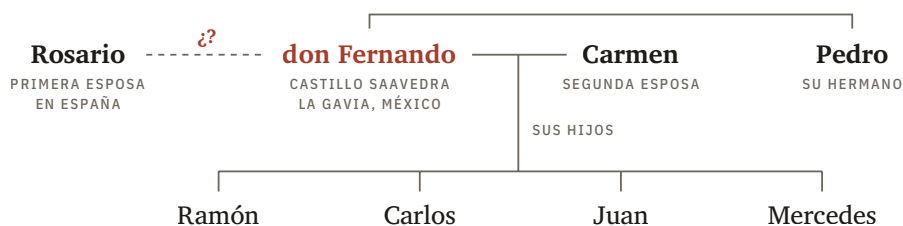
Don Fernando Castillo is a very old man and he is ill. He lives at La Gavia, an estate in Mexico.

A woman from Spain, Teresa Suárez, writes him a letter.

The letter talks about Rosario, don Fernando's first wife. He believes Rosario died in the Spanish Civil War.

Don Fernando wants to know the truth. Raquel is going to investigate the case, and her journey starts in Seville.

QUIÉN ES QUIÉN

Who's who

Raquel Rodríguez abogada, de Los Ángeles

the lawyer who tells the story

Teresa Suárez una señora de Sevilla, España

writes the letter

VOCABULARIO

Words to keep

LA FAMILIA

el padre	father
la madre	mother
el hijo · la hija	son · daughter
los hijos	children (sons and daughters)
el hermano · la hermana	brother · sister
el nieto · la nieta	grandson · granddaughter
el esposo · la esposa	husband · wife
la familia	family

PERSONAS

el abogado · la abogada	lawyer
el señor · la señora	man · woman (polite)
don · doña	title of respect + first name

EL CASO

la carta	letter
el secreto	secret
la verdad	truth
la guerra	war
el caso	case
el viaje	journey; trip

DESCRIBIR

viejo · vieja	old
enfermo · enferma	ill; sick
primero · primera	first
muy	very
también	also; too

VERBOS

Verbs

ser IRREGULAR

to be (who or what someone is)

yo	soy
tú	eres
él · ella · usted	es
nosotros/as	somos
vosotros/as	sois
ellos · ellas · ustedes	son

ALSO IN THIS EPISODE

llamarse	me llamo · se llama	to be called
vivir	vive	to live
trabajar	trabaja	to work
escribir	escribe	to write
creer	cree	to believe
querer	quiere	to want; e becomes ie
saber	no sé · sabe	to know (a fact)
ir a + verb	va a investigar	is going to ...

GRAMÁTICA

Grammar

1.1 Ser: saying who someone is

Use **ser** to say who someone is, what they do and where they come from. Spanish usually drops the subject: *Soy Raquel* is more natural than *Yo soy Raquel*, because the ending already tells you who. Did you notice *está enfermo*? For how someone **is right now** (ill, tired, happy), Spanish switches to **estar**. That contrast comes back in later episodes.

Raquel es abogada.

Raquel is a lawyer.

Teresa Suárez es de España.

Teresa Suárez is from Spain.

Ramón y Carlos son hermanos.

Ramón and Carlos are brothers.

WATCH OUT No *un/una* before a job: **Raquel es abogada**, not ~~Raquel es una abogada~~. The article comes back only when you add an adjective: *Es una abogada muy buena*.

1.2 El or la: every noun has a gender

Learn every noun with its article. Most nouns in **-o** are masculine, most in **-a** are feminine, but the article is what you can trust: *el viaje*, *la verdad*. A masculine plural covers a mixed group, so *los hijos de don Fernando* includes his daughter Mercedes.

el hijo · los hijos

the son · the children

la carta · las cartas

the letter · the letters

el abogado · la abogada

the lawyer (man · woman)

WATCH OUT *Los padres* means **parents**, not only fathers. *Mis padres* = my mother and my father.

1.3 Asking: ¿Quién? ¿Dónde? ¿De dónde?

The narrator keeps asking you questions, and you can answer them out loud. Question words carry an accent, and a question opens with *¿*.

¿Quién es Rosario?

Who is Rosario?

¿Dónde vive don Fernando?

Where does don Fernando live?

¿De dónde es Teresa?

Where is Teresa from?

WATCH OUT No 's in Spanish. Possession goes with **de**: *la carta de Teresa*, *el hermano de don Fernando*.

FRASES ÚTILES

Ready to use

Me llamo Raquel.

My name is Raquel.

¿Cómo se llama?

What is his / her / your name?

Es de Los Ángeles.

She's from Los Angeles.

Vive en México.

He lives in Mexico.

Es el hermano de don Fernando.

He is don Fernando's brother.

¿Quién es?

Who is it? / Who is he / she?

No sé.

I don't know.

Quiere saber la verdad.

He wants to know the truth.

BUENO SABER

Good to know

PRONUNCIACIÓN

R at the start of a word

An **r** at the start of a word is rolled, just like **rr**. Every name in this episode is practice: **Raquel**, **Rodríguez**, **Rosario**, and **guerra**. Between vowels a single **r** is one quick tap: *Teresa*, *primera*. Say *pero* (but) and *perro* (dog) until they sound different.

CULTURA

Don, doña, and two surnames

Don and *doña* go before a **first name** to show respect to an older person: *don Fernando*, never ~~*don*~~ *Castillo*. And Spanish speakers carry two surnames, father's first and mother's second: *Fernando Castillo Saavedra*. After the Civil War (1936–1939), Mexico took in thousands of refugees from Spain.

MIS NOTAS

Your own
